II

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FJ 10310/30

SECRET:

JAPANESE PEACE TREATY: DEBATE ON NOVEMBER 26th

In addition to the questions covered in the briefs already put up, there is one further point to which I think we should draw Mr. Nutting's attention before the Debate. This is the possibility that Mr. Younger, or other Opposition speakers, may use the argument put forward by the then Minister of State in his minute of September 18th, to the effect that we ought to delay our own ratification of the Peace Treaty for long enough to make sure that the U.S. Government are not going to double cross us on the Formosa issue by waiting until our own ratification is safely through and then pushing the Japanese into some step towards Chiang Kai Shek which, if taken earlier, would have imperilled our own ratification, but, once that was through, could safely be used by the U.S. Government as a means of facilitating their own ratification.

FLAG A.

FJ10310/8

We put this argument to Sir E. Dening in a letter dated September 21st, and he replied on October 8th that he nevertheless thought we should not hold up ratification, since this would irritate both the Japanese and the Americans and fail in its object - since if United States internal politics resulted in the U.S. Government deciding to force Japan into a Treaty with Chiang Kai Shek, delay in ratification on our part would not deter them. The Secretary of State decided on October 31st that we should be guided by Sir E. Dening's recommendation and go ahead with ratification as soon as possible.

FLAG B.

FJ10310/11

The case against delay on this score has ~~mainly~~ since been strengthened by Mr. Acheson's assurance to the Secretary of State in Paris (Paris telegram No. 570) to the effect that there would be no question of the Japanese reaching any formal arrangement with the authorities in Formosa until after the Peace Treaty had come into force.

FLAG C.

FJ10310/25

The foregoing is for Mr. Nutting's background information only. If the point is raised by the Opposition during the Debate, we ~~could~~ would be able to suggest a suitable answer for the President of the Board of Trade to include in his winding up speech.

C.H. Johnston.

(C. H. Johnston)
24th November, 1951.

Mr. Nutting

I should like the President to have a minute of Mr. Acheson's assurance as possible to give to the House — without, of course, attributing them to him personally.

P.R.B. 24/11

Stephen
Mr Barclay

JA
24/11
Nov. 25

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FO 371/92605
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